

Written Project Report Sections

The written report has a required format and should include certain sections as a minimum. Here are some details and guidance on what to include in each section.

1. Executive summary

This section expands on the report's title and gives the reader a 'snapshot' of what the report is about. The executive summary is usually written last and includes the purpose of the report, methods used to investigate the topic, and an overview of the findings and key recommendations and conclusions.

At the beginning of a written report you would also expect to see a table of contents with the page numbers of the main sections or sub-sections, as well as a list of charts and diagrams – or your project implementation plan where appropriate – and any appendices.

2. Introduction

The introduction 'sets the scene' for the report's subject. To give an outline of your completed project in this way you might choose to include details on the purpose and timeframe, as well as the role you played. Where relevant, you could also include an explanation of the people involved in delivering the project and any stakeholders involved in implementation.

3. Scope and business need

This section includes any metrics, such as key performance indicators and objectives. Along with detailing the scope of the initiative, it may be possible to provide some justification for the project's business case, detailing the key aims and expected outcomes, as well as any boundaries and constraints that should be considered.

4. Research and analysis outcomes

The project is likely to have involved some research and data interpretation, of quantitative and/or qualitative data. As such, in this section you should show the high-level analysis or outcomes of the research. Remember that you can use the appendices to present data separately from the main body of the report if needed.

5. Project outcomes

Did the project deliver the benefits anticipated? Was it completed on time and in line with costs? You are likely to refer to the aims and objectives at this point, as well as detailed project plans and implementation and monitoring documents in your appendices – such as a work breakdown structure or Gantt chart. You may also refer to any cost–benefit analyses,

project budgets, or end-of-project documentation that supports and highlights output and process outcomes.

6. Discussion of findings

Up to this point, you will have been presenting facts and figures about the project, but at the discussion stage you can include your own interpretations where appropriate. For example, you may want to include opinions about how the project progressed and any influencing factors or explanations that could help the reader understand more about your project and the project management process you followed. The discussion should still be based on evidence where possible, so you'll likely refer to the information in your appendices, such as data sets or facts and figures included in tables, graphs and charts.

7. Conclusions and recommendations

This section refers to the report's objectives and sets out your case on how well they were met and what else might need to be done in the future. You should aim to ensure that your suggested approach is actionable and feasible in your organisational context and present the benefits of your recommendations and why you have made them. You might go on to outline next steps or even include a high-level implementation plan that indicates timings, costs and resources.

8. References

Towards the end of the report you will include a list of any references that you used – across internal resources and external publications, data sources, or other materials that you presented throughout the report.

9. Appendices

Appendices usually contain information that is useful for readers as background detail or for reference but not essential to include as part of the main text.

It's important to include an appendix that shows how the apprenticeship standard's knowledge, skills and behaviours (KSBs) map to the report so that you can make it clear how each element has been met. You must also produce and include an appendix to show how the report evidences the KSBs mapped to this end point assessment method. This mapping is usually made up of a grid containing all the KSB themes and standard numbers, with reference to where each one can be found in the report.

If you have referred to any other information in appendices – such as tables or data sets – throughout the report, you should also include these appendices here as supplementary information and label them properly.